and DGs of Line Dtes, stepping on a few toes in the bargain. Once again, there was opposition to change, and no model was ideal, each having its own advantages and disadvantages. By the time it was presented to us Army Commanders during the Army Commanders' Conference in April 2018, it was already on iteration Model 14A. I was then the Army Commander ARTRAC, and the changes being proposed would significantly and positively impact the ARTRAC. Interestingly, the then CNS, Admiral Lamba, had visited HQ ARTRAC in 2018. During our interaction, he had asked me a very pertinent question, that since there was an ARTRAC looking after all issues concerning training, what was the role of the DGMT and did it not amount to duplication of effort? I was able to honestly respond that indeed what he had observed was correct and that this was precisely one of the issues being dealt with in the restructuring of the Army HQ.

One of the major changes contemplated was the creation of the appointment of a third DCOAS, a DCOAS (Strategy), to whom the DGMO, DGMI and DGPP would report. This was an operational imperative to ensure that the inputs being received through different channels could be filtered and analysed at a single point and only then presented to the Chief. I remembered my experience from my PP Dte days, when I had analysed that the PLA had reduced the number of their Group Armies (equivalent to our Corps) from twenty-one to nineteen, which had been pooh-poohed by both the MO and MI Dtes, but which later turned out to be true. The MI even went as far as to say that they had even checked with the resident DA, China, who had negated this reduction. Therefore, the long-term assessments of the PP Dte had to be balanced against the short-term inputs of the MI, before being matched against activities on both sides of the border being reported to the MO Dte in

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